

# Steven Ngo

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING PH.D. STUDENT · COLLEGIATE CYBER DEFENSE COMPETITION '25 NATIONAL CHAMPION

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## Education

### University of California, Irvine

PH.D. SOFTWARE ENGINEERING

- Advisor: Dr. Joshua Garcia

Irvine, California

Sep. 2023 - present

### California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo

B.S. SOFTWARE ENGINEERING

- Minor in Psychology
- GPA: 3.9 (Summa Cum Laude)
- Research Mentors: Ayaan Kazerouni, Dongfeng Fang, Zachary Peterson

San Luis Obispo, California

Sep. 2019 - Jun. 2023

## Professional Experience

### INDUSTRY

2026 **Technical Product Manager Intern**, Animal Outpatient Specialty Network

2025 **Data Analyst (Contractor)**, Turing

2024 **Security Research Engineer Intern**, Samsung Research America

2021 **Product Security Intern**, GoDaddy

2019 - 2021 **HR Technology Student Intern**, County of San Luis Obispo

### ACADEMIA

2026 **Graduate Student Researcher**, Dept. of Informatics, University of California, Irvine

2023, 2025 **Graduate Teaching Assistant**, Dept. of Informatics, University of California, Irvine

2021 - 2023 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, Dept. of Computer Science and Software Engineering, Cal Poly SLO

2022 **Summer Undergraduate Research Assistant**, Info. Sciences Institute, University of Southern California

## Publications

### PUBLISHED

**S. Ngo**, A. Rohatgi, J. Garcia. 2026. *Netsiege: A Long-Form, Club-Led King-of-the-Hill Competition for Accessible Cybersecurity Training*. To Appear at the Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education (SIGCSE) 2027. (~25.8% acceptance rate)

J. Ayala, **S. Ngo**, J. Garcia. 2026. *Between Risk, Recognition, and Necessity: How Open-Source Project Maintainers Perceive and Navigate CVEs Through Reporting and Resolving Vulnerabilities*. To Appear at the ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS) 2026.

J. Ayala, **S. Ngo**, J. Garcia. 2025. *A Deep Dive Into How Open-Source Project Maintainers Perceive, Review, and Resolve Bug Bounty Reports*. IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy (S&P) 2025. (~14.3% acceptance rate)

### IN REVIEW

**S. Ngo**, J. Ayala, J. Garcia. 2026. *Investigating Educational Collaborations with Upcycled Computing Equipment on Student-Run Cybersecurity Clubs*.

J. Ayala, Y. Tung, **S. Ngo**, J. Garcia. 2026. *A Mixed-Methods Study On Vulnerability Disclosure Practices in Open-Source Software Using Bug Bounty Reports*.

## Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

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|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 2025 | <b>Black Hat USA 2025 Student Scholarship</b> , Black Hat USA, Zoox                                                              |           |
|      | <b>Graduate Assistance in Areas of National Need Fellowship in Cybersecurity</b> , US Department of Education                    |           |
|      | <b>Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition National Champion</b> , Center for Infrastructure Assurance and Security                 |           |
| 2024 | <b>Cal-Bridge University of California Doctoral Fellowship</b> , Cal-Bridge                                                      |           |
|      | <b>Catalyst Award</b> , DARPA & Tools Competition, Building an Adaptive and Competitive Workforce                                | \$ 50,000 |
|      | <b>Certificate in Course Design</b> , UC Irvine Division of Teaching Excellence and Innovation, Course Design Essentials Program |           |
| 2023 | <b>Informatics Department Chair's Award</b> , UC Irvine, Dept. of Informatics                                                    |           |
|      | <b>Cal-Bridge Computer Science and Engineering Scholarship</b> , Cal-Bridge                                                      |           |
| 2022 | <b>Northrop Grumman Foundation Scholarship Endowment</b> , Cal Poly SLO, Dept. of CSSE                                           |           |

## Presentations

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### INVITED TALKS

- Aug. 2026. *Student-Run Cybersecurity Clubs: Why They Matter & Digital Playgrounds*. DEFCON 34, Las Vegas, NV.
- Oct. 2025. *The Untapped Pipeline of the Cybersecurity Industry: Reflections on Cyber Clubs*. OSSCON '25, Fullerton, CA.
- Jun. 2025. *Students as Cyber Guardians: Pioneering AI Security in Higher Education*. UC Tech '25, Riverside, CA.
- Feb. 2024. *School of Hard Hacks: Experiences and Insights on College-Level Cybersecurity Education*. Irvine Underground Feb. '24, Irvine, CA.

## Teaching Experience

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|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Fall 2025   | <b>Requirement Analysis &amp; Engineering</b> , Graduate Teaching Assistant          |
| Fall 2023   | <b>Intro. to Software Engineering</b> , Graduate Teaching Assistant                  |
| Spring 2023 | <b>Intro. to Computer Security</b> , Undergraduate Teaching Assistant                |
| Winter 2023 | <b>Binary Exploitation: Tools and Techniques</b> , Undergraduate Teaching Assistant  |
| Fall 2022   | <b>Intro to Computer Security</b> , Undergraduate Teaching Assistant                 |
| Fall 2021   | <b>Individual Software Design and Development</b> , Undergraduate Teaching Assistant |
| Winter 2021 | <b>Intro to Computer Security</b> , Undergraduate Teaching Assistant                 |

## Mentoring

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- 2026            **Ryan Yu**, Undergraduate Research Assistant, University of California, Irvine
- 2025 - 2026    **Akshay Rohatgi**, Undergraduate Research Assistant, University of California, Irvine

## Outreach & Professional Development

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### SERVICE AND OUTREACH

- 2026 - 2027    **Cyber@UCI Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition Team**, Student Coach
- 2026            **Business Battlefield '26**, Competition Judge
- 2025 - 2026    **National Upcycled Computing Collective**, Director of Academic Outreach
- 2024 - 2026    **Cyber@UCI**, President
- 2025            **Crack the Code Hackathon '25**, Hackathon Judge
- 2024 - 2025    **Informatics Graduate Student Association**, Treasurer
- 2024 - 2025    **Cal-Bridge Peer Mentorship Committee**, Committee Member
- 2024            **Cal-Bridge Research Symposium '24**, Session Chair
- 2022 - 2023    **Cal Poly Noyce School of Applied Computing New Director Search**, Student Representative
- 2022 - 2023    **Cal Poly Security Education Club**, President
- 2022            **Cal Poly CSSE Dept New Faculty Search**, Student Representative

### PEER REVIEW

- 2026            **Network & Distributed Systems Security (NDSS) '27**, Artifact Evaluation Committee Member
- Annual Computer Security Applications Conference (ACSAC) '26**, Artifact Evaluation Committee Member
- Intl. Conference on Software Engineering (ICSE) '27**, Shadow PC Member
- Intl. Conference on Automated Software Engineering (ASE) '26**, Artifact Evaluation Committee Member
- Intl. Symposium on Software Testing and Analysis (ISSTA) '26**, Artifact Evaluation Committee Member
- 2025            **Network & Distributed Systems Security (NDSS) '26**, Artifact Evaluation Committee Member
- IEEE Security & Privacy (S&P) '26**, Artifact Evaluation Committee Member
- Transactions on Dependable and Secure Computing (TDSC)**, Reviewer
- Transactions on Software Engineering (TSE)**, Reviewer

2024

**Network & Distributed Systems Security (NDSS) '25**, Artifact Evaluation Committee Member

**Intl. Conference on Software Architecture (ICSA) '24**, Artifact Evaluation Committee Member